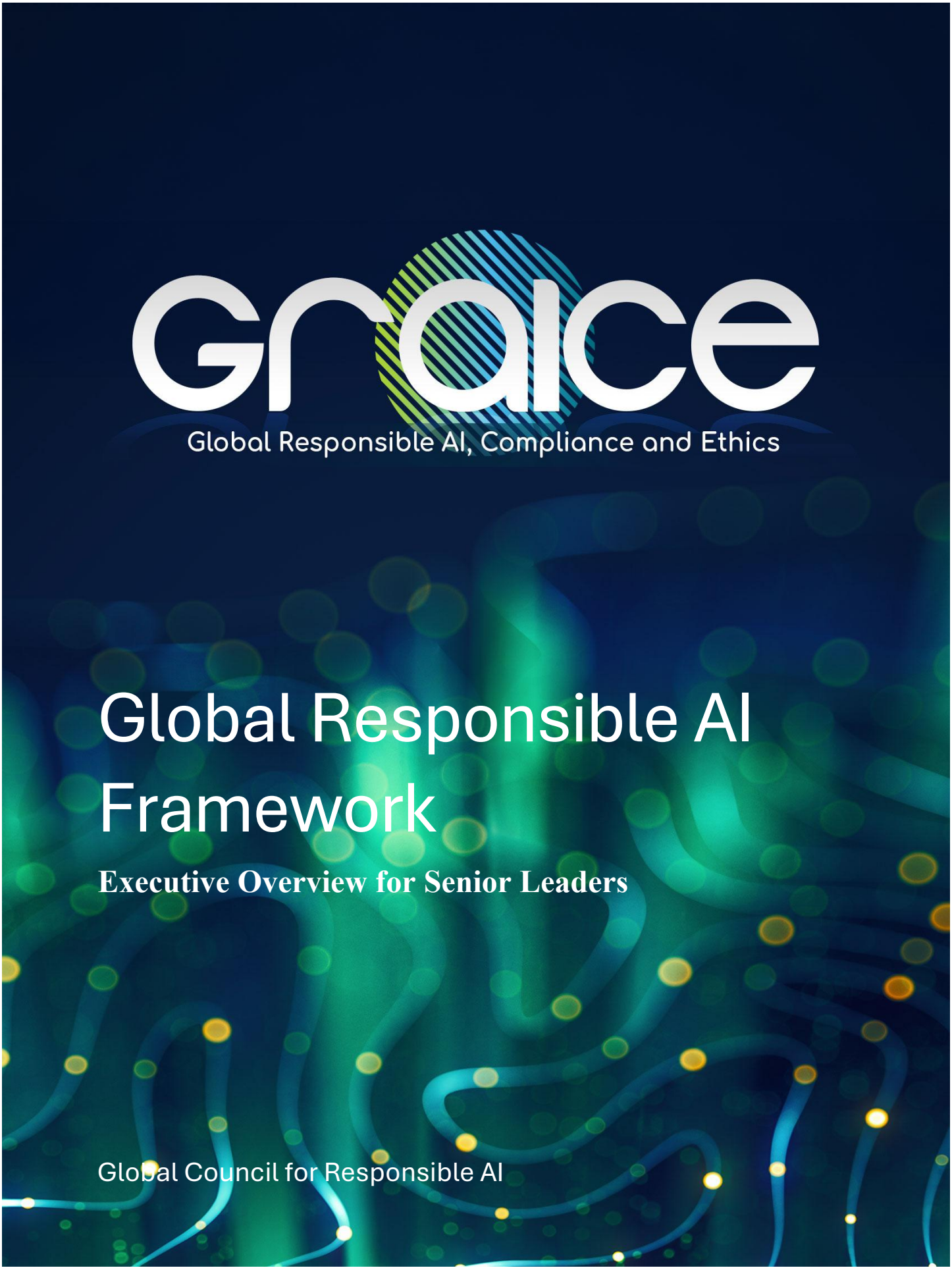


Global Responsible AI Framework

Executive Overview for Senior Leaders

Global Council for Responsible AI

Why This Framework Exists

Artificial Intelligence is no longer a distant or abstract technology. It is shaping how people are seen, evaluated, employed, informed, governed, and treated across societies. Decisions made by humans alone are increasingly influenced, assisted, or automated by systems that operate at global scale and unprecedented speed.

When intelligence is deployed at scale, its impact is not technical alone. It becomes social, economic, political, and deeply human. It affects dignity, agency, opportunity, safety, and trust. Without shared responsibility, these systems can quietly entrench inequity, obscure accountability, and distance people from decisions that affect their lives.

The GRAICE™ (Global Responsible AI Compliance & Ethics) Framework exists to respond to this moment. GRAICE™ is humanity's operating system for AI, a globally governed framework that operationalizes AI governance with measurable oversight and accountability

It was created to help humanity govern artificial intelligence in ways that preserve human dignity, protect societal trust, and ensure that innovation serves people rather than replaces or diminishes them. This Framework is not about slowing progress. It is about ensuring that progress remains aligned with human values, rights, and long-term well-being.

Responsible AI, as defined here, is not optional and it is not symbolic. It reflects the simple truth that power requires stewardship, and that systems capable of shaping lives at scale must be governed with care, transparency, and accountability.

This Framework provides a shared foundation so that governments, organizations, institutions, and communities can work from a common understanding of what responsible use of intelligence requires. It is designed to be inclusive, globally adaptable, and grounded in evidence rather than rhetoric.

At its heart, the Framework seeks to answer three questions that matter to all people:

1. How can AI strengthen human dignity and agency rather than undermine them?
2. How do we make responsibility for AI decisions visible, accountable, and verifiable?
3. How can societies innovate confidently while protecting trust, fairness, and safety for current and future generations?

The Core Logic of the Framework

The Framework is designed as an integrated system rather than a collection of policies. Its logic is intentionally simple and repeatable:

Values → Pillars → Assurance → Governance

- **Foundational Values** establish non-negotiable ethical and human-centered boundaries
- **Seven Pillars** translate values into operational requirements
- **Assurance Tiers** verify that requirements are met with evidence
- **Governance Structures** assign accountability and decision authority

The Six Foundational Values

All responsible AI practices under this Framework are grounded in six universal values:

1. Human Dignity and Autonomy
2. Accountability and Governance
3. Fairness and Justice
4. Transparency and Explainability
5. Reliability and Security
6. Inclusivity and Societal Benefit

These values apply across the entire AI lifecycle and across all sectors and jurisdictions. They define what must never be compromised, regardless of business model or technology.

The Seven Pillars of Responsible AI

The values are operationalized through seven pillars that define what responsible AI must achieve in practice:

1. Ethical Leadership
2. Purpose-Driven Innovation
3. Human-Centric Use
4. Responsible Implementation
5. AI Literacy and Workforce Readiness
6. Data Governance and Integrity
7. Transparency and Auditability

Each pillar includes clear expectations, key questions for leadership, implementation pathways scaled by organizational size, and evidence artifacts required for assurance.

Governance Architecture and Accountability

The Framework establishes a clear governance architecture to prevent ethical responsibility from being diffused or delegated to technology alone.

Three Levels of Governance

Level 1 — Organizational Governance

- Board and executive accountability
- Ethical leadership, risk appetite, and resource allocation
- Approval of AI governance policies and assurance strategy

Level 2 — System Governance

- Oversight of individual AI systems
- Approval of deployment, updates, and retirement
- Review of risks, performance, drift, and incidents

Level 3 — Independent and External Governance

- Independent audits and assessments
- Certification and public-facing assurance
- Regulatory and multi-stakeholder oversight

Defined Roles and Decision Rights

The Framework specifies clear roles such as Responsible AI Officer, System Owner, Data Governance Lead, Human Oversight Lead, and Independent Reviewer. Decision rights are explicitly defined for:

- Deployment approval
- Risk acceptance
- System pause or shutdown
- Escalation to independent review
- Certification and external disclosure

This structure ensures accountability is traceable, enforceable, and auditable.

The Three-Tier Assurance Model

Responsible AI requires proof, not promises. The Framework therefore includes a progressive assurance model that allows organizations to demonstrate maturity and trustworthiness proportionate to system risk.

Tier 1 — Organizational Readiness

- Confirms governance foundations, leadership accountability, policies, and workforce capability
- Establishes baseline alignment with responsible AI principles
- Required before system-level assurance

Tier 2 — System-Level Assurance

- Verifies that a specific AI system meets all seven pillars
- Requires documented testing, data governance, oversight, monitoring, and lifecycle controls
- Can be performed internally or by accredited internal audit functions

Tier 3 — Independent Assessment

- Provides external, impartial verification
- Supports certification and public assurance for high-impact systems
- Enables global trust and cross-border recognition

The assurance model is lifecycle-based and continuous. Reassessment is triggered by system updates, data changes, incidents, or shifts in risk or context.

Global Interoperability and Executive Value

Global Alignment and Interoperability

The Framework is designed as a global meta-framework. It does not replace existing regulations or standards. Instead, it connects them through a harmonized structure that allows organizations to:

- Operate across jurisdictions with consistent governance
- Reuse evidence for multiple regulatory and audit requirements
- Adapt implementation to local cultural and legal contexts
- Engage credibly with regulators, partners, and the public

Executive Value Proposition

For senior leaders, the Framework delivers:

- Clear accountability for AI decisions and outcomes
- Reduced regulatory, legal, and reputational risk
- Stronger trust with customers, citizens, investors, and partners
- Scalable governance that supports innovation rather than blocking it
- A defensible, auditable position on responsible AI

Strategic Outcome

When implemented effectively, the Global Responsible AI Framework enables organizations to:

- Operationalize ethical commitments
- Safeguard human dignity and societal interests
- Demonstrate accountability with evidence
- Earn and sustain public trust
- Innovate responsibly at global scale

Responsible AI becomes not a constraint, but a strategic capability and a source of long-term legitimacy.